

much as they can about you - the metadata of your life is the product they're trading in. Sometimes, the 'Terms and Conditions' that you sign could sign you up for annoying marketing, or even phone calls - try to steer clear of websites of poor repute.

There are other options, but they're even harder to find, and the rewards aren't transferrable. Some companies will offer you bonuses or special offers to sample and review their products. Google Maps allows you to sign up as a 'Local Explorer' and answer questions about places you visit, rewarding you with things like free Google Drive space and early access to cool offers and features. But these are out of the way - the bulk of survey-based earnings will come from the run-of-the-mill sites that want to mine your life for profit.



It does indeed...

But for the most part, prepare to be thoroughly objectified as a consumer. That's pretty much what you're being paid for - an obscene item number where your personal habits are the goods.

### **Okay, sign me up!**

You're a brave one, aren't you. If you're still interested, or perhaps, if you're that desperate, dive right in. Here are some things to keep in mind:

- It's probably worth your while to create a fake email address for these surveys
- Be sure to read the fine-print for anything you sign up for
- Be extra careful when giving out your address, phone number, or real name
- Be extra, extra, extra careful before paying any money - this can't be stressed enough
- Do your research - find a rewards site that works for you and stick with it 